

195 Create a woodland terrarium

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Woodland trees provide food and shelter for squirrels and deer, but the leaves they lose are home to millions of tiny creatures, such as beetles, spiders, and centipedes. Build a terrarium to find out what lives in your local leaf litter.

What you need

- Trowel
- 3 plastic bags
- Old aquarium
- Small, shallow bowl
- Spray bottle
- Magnifying glass

1 Use the trowel to put dry and moist leaf litter in one plastic bag. Put soil from other places in the second bag, and bark, small branches, and cones in the third.

2 Spread soil on the aquarium floor and put a half-full bowl of water in one corner. Add leaf litter, branches, cones, and bark. Spray with water, then secure the lid in place.

3 Put the terrarium somewhere cool and shady. Spray it every day and top off the water dish. Feed any snails with lettuce leaves. Use the magnifying glass to spot animals. Once you've finished studying the creatures, take them back to where you found them and let them go.



196 Follow an ant trail

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Find a nest or put some honey on the ground. Once the ants form a trail, put a leaf across their path. See how long it takes them to go around it.

